

ONLINE COMMAND & CONTROL

How to avoid being controlled, threatened, limited, blocked, restricted in anyway whatsoever. It's difficult, privacy is a process not a product. But with some time and effort, getting close to perfect is possible.

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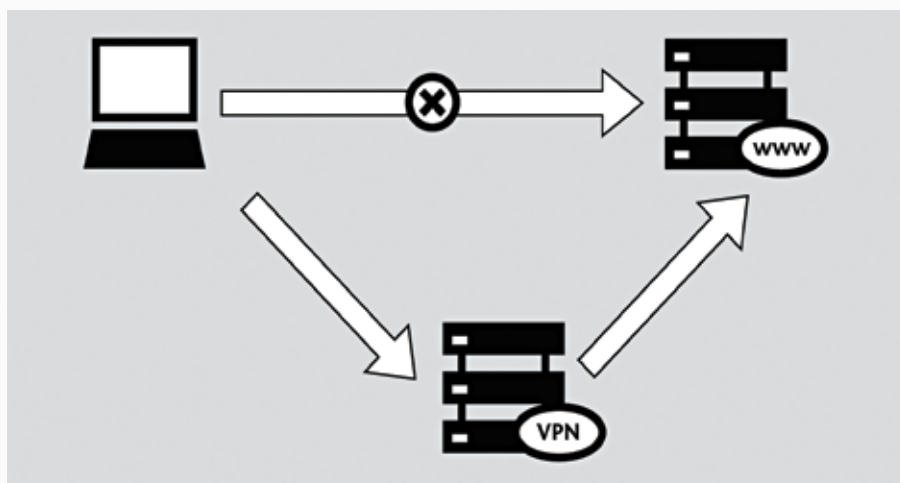
There are some things that are just plain illogical. Like defining broadband in kbps (what is this, TRAI, 2005?), selling unlimited bandwidth at 20GB monthly caps (you, too clever for your own good ISPs, you!), and the existence of late 20th century relics known as “STD/ISD/PCO” (seriously, who still uses them?). Then there are other things that are more alarming than trivial, for their ability to set a dangerous precedent. Something that denies you your basic freedom even. For all of us who can't live without the Internet, who co-exist harmoniously in the Digital Age of the 21st century, wanton censorship of the Web is akin to denial of one's liberty. The freedom to access anything that can be accessed legally. In the wise words of Henry Ward Beecher (and a certain character portrayed by Matt Damon), what is freedom or liberty if not a soul's right to breathe? And when it cannot take a long breath, laws are girdled too tight. “Without liberty, man is a syncope.” Do watch Good Will Hunting, it's a fascinating movie, especially this court monologue citing Beecher.

Not only is liberty to move around freely on the Internet's digital highways a prerequisite in the modern world, we also don't want to be collateral victims of mass surveillance programs whenever we happen to be on the Internet and the World Wide Web. For what is censorship or filtering of Internet if not the first steps towards monitoring or surveillance? Not only freedom, we value our privacy online as well, which isn't too much to ask for in a

land of democratic values is it now? Turns out, it isn't a simple yes or no answer.

It's all about control

Who is able to restrict access to the Internet on any given computer in any given country depends on who has the ability to control specific parts of the technical infrastructure. This control may be based on legally established relationships or requirements, or on the ability of



Deploying a VPN is a tried and tested method to bypass online censorship